PANELTEC PTY LTD

P O Box 148 Kings Meadows, TAS 7249
ABN: 12 128 689 412

SWMS-41

SAFE WORK METHOD STATEMENT

Persons responsible for supervising, inspecting work, work methods, plant & equipment and tools	**Supervisor/Foreman:**	**Date:**	
High Risk Construction Work:	**SITE CLEARING INVOLVING REMOVAL OF TREES & GRASSES, ETC**	**Project:**	
SWMS prepared by Patrick Monaghan - Paneltec Group -Operations Manager and in consultation with management and workers – 2025 *SWMS Review Date: August 2026 unless required earlier* **Signature:**		**Location:**	

Approval to use this SWMS: "I certify that the attached SWMS has been reviewed by me, is endorsed for compliance with WorkSafe guidelines and is approved for use"

John Guy	Director - Paneltec Pty Ltd	0408 449 023		31/08/2025 – V12.0
Name	**Position**	☎	**Signature**	**Date**

RISK MATRIX

Level	Description of Consequence or Impact	Consequence	Likelihood / Probability L *Likely*	M *Moderate*	U Unlikely
H (1) *(High level of harm)*	Potential death, permanent disability or major structural failure/damage. Off-site environmental discharge/release not contained and significant long-term environmental harm.	H (1) *(High)*	1	1	2
M (2) *(Medium level of harm)*	Potential temporary disability or minor structural failure/damage. On-site environmental discharge/release contained, minor remediation required, short-term environmental harm.	M (2) *(Medium)*	1	2	3
L (3) *(Low level of harm)*	Incident that has the potential to cause persons to require first aid. On-site environmental discharge/release immediately contained, minor level clean up with no short-term environmental harm.	L (3) *(Low)*	2	3	3

Level	Likelihood / Probability
Likely	Could happen frequently
Moderate	Could happen occasionally
Unlikely	May occur only in exceptional circumstances

HIERARCHY OF RISK CONTROL

The hierarchy of controls must be applied in the order below for all identified hazards.

Level 1 **Eliminate the hazard**
Level 2 **Substitute the hazard with something safer.**
Level 3 **Isolate the hazard from people.** **Reduce the risks through engineering controls.**
Level 4 **Reduce exposure to the hazard using administrative actions.**
Level 5 **Use personal protective equipment**
The control measures that you put in place should be reviewed regularly to make sure they work as planned

ACTIVITY ANALYSIS

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
General safety measures.	Persons injured when clearing site	**1**	1. The site clearing operation should be thoroughly planned to ensure that all parties are aware of the health & safety requirements of the workplace. • The method used depends upon the extent of the task, the type of country, the time available, and the equipment and labour available. 2. Clearing usually involves the removal of vegetation such as grass, brush, trees and stumps. Removal by mechanical means is the preferred method where possible (dozer, excavator, grader). 3. Clearing by chainsaw is to be used as second preference. 4. Operational flashing lights and reversing/travel beepers on all earthmoving equipment. 5. All workers should have been inducted to the company safety processes and be in possession of the relevant tickets of competency for operating plant and equipment. 6. All workers to wear safety vests and other relevant PPE. (eg Steel toe safety boots, safety helmet, hearing protection, eye protection, gloves and chainsaw operators should also wear face protection and cut resistant leg protection) 7. **Machine operators must not operate** whilst a chainsaw operator is working, or a person is on foot and is in the vicinity of the work (to avoid flicking timber etc). 8. **The Chainsaw operator or any other persons on foot should not enter** the area whilst machinery is operating. 9. **Machinery operator and persons on foot must make visual or verbal acknowledgement** before commencing their proposed task.	Supervisor Operator	**2**
Visitor control	Injury to members of the public.	**1**	1. Site clearing can be a threat to the general public – the work area should be barricaded off or signed appropriately to restrict access and minimise the plant working area.	Supervisor Operator	**2**

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
Machine Pre Start Check	Unsafe machines can cause injury.	**1**	1. Equipment Pre start checklist forms filled out & defects documented, supervisor notified. 2. Ensure windows/ mirrors are clean. 3. Ensure all controls are in neutral or park. 4. Ensure all gear in the cabin is correctly stored. 5. Adjust the seat and use the seat belt.	Operator	**2**
Equipment pre-start checks	Unsafe equipment can cause injury.	**1**	1. All equipment including ropes and line, upon which the workers and operator must rely for their safety, must be inspected by the worker each day before use. 2. All ropes and lines must at all times be stored separate to chemicals fuel, chainsaws, other cutting tools and equipment. 3. Chainsaws must conform to the applicable provisions of AS 2726. Part 1 and Part 2.	Operator Workers	**2**
Machine Starting checks	Unsafe operation. Increased likelihood of accident during operation.	**1**	1. The operator must be seated and in full control of the machine when starting. 2. Check the operation of all of the controls and gauges. 3. Listen and watch for defects. 4. Test hydraulic functions. 5. Ensure all grounded attachments are safely retracted 6. Test lights, horn and travel alarm. Check safety locking pins in quick hitch are locked for buckets or attachments.	Operator	**2**
Plant & Equipment Operation	Unsafe operations. Potential injuries to personnel	**1**	1. Refer to other company Safe Work Method Statements and Safe Work Instructions for the safe operation of plant and equipment. • **SWMS – General Excavation & Trenching** • **SWMS – Safe Operation of a Grader**	Operator	**2**
Clearing equipment	Unsafe operations Potential injuries to personnel	**1**	1. La Bounty shears attached to the excavator should be used cut trees up to eliminate the need for a chainsaw operator to work amongst timber. 2. All equipment including ropes and line, upon which the worker must rely for his/her safety, must be inspected by the worker each day before use.	Operator	**2**

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
Brushcutter safety	Unsafe operation Potential injuries to personnel	**1**	1. Personal protective clothing (ear muffs, goggles or face shield, gloves, steel-capped boots etc.) 2. Correctly adjusted equipment (safety harness) 3. Organize work to a system 4. Maintain a safe working distance from other persons 5. Quick decisions Run blade at full speed before starting a cut 6. Use thigh and leg muscles to move the saw 7. Control the direction of fall 8. Do not touch sawn-off stems.	Operator	**2**
Chainsaw safety	Unsafe operation. Potential injuries to personnel	**1**	1. Chainsaws must conform to the applicable provisions of AS 2726. Part 1 and Part 2. 2. Use and operation of chainsaws must be in accordance with the applicable provisions of AS 2727. 3. PPE – a chainsaw operator must not only ensure that the machine is in safe operating condition but must also wear protective clothing for optimum protection. 4. Head Protection *(hard hat*). A hard hat should be worn at all times as protection from failing material, and to reduce injuries from kickback. 5. Ear Protection (ear muffs/ear plugs). All operators and assistants etc. should wear suitable ear protection. Chainsaws operate in the region of 100-110 dB(A) at the operator's ear, therefore careful consideration must be given to the attenuation of the ear protector. 6. Eye Protection (goggles/glasses/mesh & perspex screens). The chain on the saw rotates at more than 40 km/h, so chips and material can be flung at the operator's eyes at very high speed. 7. Leg Protection (trousers/chaps) leg protectors in a variety of kevlars and nylons are most effective in preventing cuts to the operators legs – a common problem. 8. Foot Protection (safety boots). These should have steel toe caps, non-slip deep tread soles or have metal sprigs or cleats to protect toes from saw cuts and feet from failing material.	Competent Chainsaw operator	**2**

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
			9. Hand Protection (gloves/mittens). As well as protecting hands from cuts, abrasions etc. & keeping them warm, they prevent vibration induced problems such as Raynaud's Disease. 10. The chain saw - The chainsaw should be equipped with the following items: • A chain brake (preferably automatic) to prevent injury in the event of kickback. • Interlock throttle system, to prevent uncontrolled • activation of the throttle. • Chain catcher and rear hand protector, to protect the saw and operator in the event of chain breakage. • Anti-vibration system, to reduce exposure to vibration. • A low-kick chain (safety chain) to provide protection from kickback. 11. OPERATOR SAFETY *CHAINSAW KICKBACK* Other than the obvious risk of physical contact with a moving chain, the *single most dangerous aspect of the saw is 'kickback'.* This occurs when the bar nose contacts an object, resulting in an instantaneous kick reaction. Severe injuries and sometimes death can result. To prevent kickback: • Avoid using the bar nose. Always be alert to anything coming in contact with the bar nose. • Ensure that safety chain is used, and that it is correctly sharpened and tensioned. • Always operate with two hands on the saw handles, with the thumb of the left hand placed under the front handle. • Avoid the use of the saw above the shoulders and always keep the saw in front of the body. 12. CHAINSAW OPERATION • Before attempting to do anything with the chainsaw READ THE MANUAL.		

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
			• Ensure that all safety features are fitted and operational *before* starting to saw; that all nuts, covers, etc. are secure. • To start, place saw on ground, with foot through rear hand guard to steady the saw. • When crosscutting or pruning, check if any branches are 'under tension' before cutting. • Seek advice and or training in the use of the chainsaw. Many accidents are the result of ignorance. • Always wear the recommended personal protective clothing. 13. FELLING OF TREES Tree felling should be carried out by trained and experienced personnel only. Assistance and advice should be sought if the operator is unsure how to fell a certain tree. 14. FIRE SAFETY Chainsaws can easily start fires, for two reasons: • Poorly maintained and/or faulty exhaust systems. • 2. Ignition of spilt fuels by internal sparks. *To avoid fires:* • Ensure muffler is in good condition and fitted with a spark arrester screen. • Keep muffler clean of carbon buildup and deposit. • Ensure that saw is correctly tuned. • Do not use on extreme fire danger days. • Do not spill fuel over saw when refuelling.		
Felling of trees	Unsafe operation. Potential injuries to personnel	**1**	1. Before beginning any felling operation, the worker must carefully consider: • Soundness of the tree. • Surrounding objects that could interfere with the safe undertaking of the operation. • Shape and weight distributions of the canopy. • Lean of the tree.	Operators	**2**

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
			• Wind force, direction, and consistency. • Proximity of tree to nearby services (e.g. overhead powerlines). • Nature of the terrain. • Location of other persons. • Presence of "hangers" in the canopy. • Chainsaw is sharp, correctly tuned adequately filled with fuel and bar oil. 2. The work area must be cleared to permit safe working conditions, and an escape route must be planned before any cutting is started. 3. Suitable wedges must be available for use to prevent a tree falling in a direction other than that intended and/or, where necessary, to break the holding wood. 4. Each tree worker must be instructed as to exactly what he is to do. 5. Any persons not directly involved in an operation must be kept clear of the work area to a distance of a least 2 times the height of the tree. 6. Special precautions in cabling or roping a rotten, leaning or split tree must be considered if it is likely that it may fall in a direction other than the intended direction of fall. Special precautions must be taken not to over-tension such cables or ropes to the extent that excessive and potentially dangerous reactive pressures are built up within the tree. 7. The operator must move away from the tree, along the pre-pared escape route, as the tree begins to fall.		
Limbing and Sectioning	Unsafe operation. Potential injuries to personnel	**1**	1. Whenever it is possible to do so, the chainsaw operator must work on the side of the trunk opposite to that which the limb is being cut. 2. The chainsaw operator should stand on the uphill side of the work whenever possible. 3. Timber under tension must be considered hazardous.	Chainsaw operator	**2**

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
			4. When necessary the chainsaw operator must chock a log to prevent it rolling.		
Wood Chipping	Unsafe operation. Potential injuries to personnel	**1**	1. Two competent operators must be in attendance when operating a wood chipper, and unless an emergency stop device is fitted, the second person must be able to operate the controls to stop the machine in the event of an emergency. 2. Wood chippers should be fed from the side of the centre line, and the operator must immediately turn away from the feed table when the brush is taken into the rotor or feed rollers. Chippers must be fed from the curbside whenever practical. 3. The chipper chute must not be raised or removed while the rotor or disc is turning. The chipper must not be used unless a discharge chute, which is of sufficient length or design to prevent contact with nip points, is in place. 4. Material other than timber, such as stones, nails, and sweepings must not be fed into chipper. 5. The feed chute or feed table of a chipper must have sufficient height on its side members to prevent operator contact with the blades or knives during any operation. 6. The chipper must not be left unattended whilst it is running.	Operators	**2**
Stump Grinders	Unsafe operation. Potential injuries to personnel	**1**	1. Where the risk of prior chemical use to poison stumps has occurred, respiratory protection must be used.	Operator	**2**
Disposal of cleared material	Environmental hazard	**1**	1. Consideration must be given as to how cleared material is to be disposed of. Timber may be burnt if environmental conditions allow, but otherwise it has to be carted away and disposed of as landfill where possible. 2. Following clearing operations, topsoil should be stripped and stockpiled for future landscaping. Topsoil is unsuitable for embankment or road building, and it is a valuable resource which should be handled and used thoughtfully.	Supervisor Operator	**2**

ENVIRONMENTAL RISK ASSESSMENT & CONTROL MEASURES THAT MAY BE REQUIRED ON SITE DEPENDING ON THE ACTIVITY					
Work Activity Risk	**Hazard**	**Risk Class**	**Risk Control Measure**	**Responsible Person/s**	**Risk Class after Controls in place**
Emergencies	Accident/ Incident Fire Spill	**1**	1. Personnel have been advised at toolbox meeting and are prepared in the event of an incident occurring. 2. Emergency numbers available on site. 3. Fire Extinguishers/First Aid Kits/Spill Kits on site.	Supervisor All	**2**
Air Quality	Exhaust Fumes Dust	**2**	1. Control exhaust emissions eg. Regular maintenance, replace old machinery, fit appropriate emission control measures. 2. Dampen milled surface with water cart. 3. Use water cart where required.	Supervisor All	**3**
Community Relations	Inconvenience as a result of works/traffic management	**2**	1. Identify from the list of potentially impacted parties who may be impacted by the work being undertaken. 2. Letter drops could be considered (unless specifically required) to notify residents/businesses etc. about works to be undertaken and if it has an effect on them.	Supervisor All	**3**
Flora & Fauna	Some works may require the removal of vegetation. Native fauna may be at risk from excavation works	**2**	1. Assess work area for significant vegetation: size of trees, faunal habitat - define work and exclusion areas using fencing and signage. 2. Machinery is to be thoroughly washed down prior to leaving site where noxious weeds are present.	Supervisor All	**3**
Heritage & Archaeology	Unmonitored excavation at significant sites can lead to loss or destruction of valuable artifacts/relics, and disturbance of historical sites. including cultural heritage and/or archaeological significance	**1**	1. Undertake a survey of the site to identify any areas of significance. The client's representative may undertake this. Government bodies may be able to assist. 2. Develop a project specific procedure based on the findings and recommendations. 3. Installation of exclusion fencing and signage if required.	Supervisor All	**2**
Noise Pollution, Community Relations & Vibration	Sensitivity to noise - to public & fauna	**1**	1. Work undertaken during "normal" hours where possible. 2. Affected residents notified in person or in writing. 3. Plant and equipment regularly serviced & fitted with efficient mufflers. 4. Magnitude of vibration reduced by using smaller plant etc.	Supervisor All	**2**

Work Activity Risk	Hazard	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class after Controls in place
Soil Management & Water Quality	Soil needs to be managed to ensure that; there are no off-site impacts. Damage to stockpile areas (not prepared properly). Mud deposited onto roadways.	**2**	1. Wash down machinery in only nominated areas. 2. Not within 20 metres of water courses. 3. Use only approved and nominated stockpile areas. 4. Build bund wall out of material available on site. 5. Drivers to check vehicle tyres/bodies for build up of mud when leaving stockpile sites and remove if necessary.	Supervisor All	**3**
Fuels and Chemicals	Contamination of waterways due to spillages of oil, degreasers, diesel, etc.	**1**	1. Store fuel and chemicals in accordance with relevant standards/guidelines. 2. Minimise storage on site and locate storage facilities away from drains and waterways. 3. All containers clearly labelled and Safety Data Sheets are available on site. 4. All drums stored securely and in a bunded area. 5. Spill kits or alternative spill containment materials available on site. 6. Regular maintenance of plant hoses. 7. Use correct refuelling equipment.	Supervisor All	**2**
Visual Impact **Litter and Amenities** **Waste Management**	Litter such as paper, plastic, and other refuse as well as being a possible safety risk may be carried off-site or washed into waterways resulting in pollution and danger to native fauna. Litter is also visually obtrusive. Production generated lighting, litter, mud, dirt and dust may also impact residents.	**2**	1. Use site induction to communicate the requirement for a tidy site. Also stress consideration for local residents. 2. If as a result of our works, dirt, mud, or litter affects a resident, then we will rectify this problem immediately. 3. Inspect the site frequently and insist on tidiness. Ensure public roads are free of dirt/mud from the work site. 4. Broken-out paved surfaces shall be repaired as soon as possible. 5. Remove all rubbish from site each day. 6. Waste products will be recycled where possible.	Supervisor All	**3**

Personal Protective Equipment						
All site personnel must wear the required PPE specified in the controls above, such as:						
Safety Hi-vis Vests/Shirts	Safety Boots	Sunscreen	Broad Brimmed Sun Hat	Sunglasses	Gloves specific to the task	White reflective overalls/night
Hard Hat where required	Safety Glasses	Hearing protection where required	Long clothing	Dust masks	Respiratory equipment if required	

Workers may require Task Specific Training depending on activity each worker will be required to fulfill.			
• All workers shall hold a current Construction Induction Card			
• If required Client Site Induction • Activity Induction (SWMS & SWP's)	• Vehicle Licences (Car or Truck depending on class of vehicle or mobile plant driven)	• Plant Operators licences or competency assessments where required	• Competencies for Work Zone Traffic Management
• First Aid certificate training	• Manual Handling training	• Fire Extinguisher training	• Fatigue Management Training

A Site Specific Induction & Toolbox Meeting will be held each day prior to the start of each job.

Legislation & Codes of Practice (refer to company Legislation register for applicable Australian Standards applicable to works)			
Work Health & Safety Act 2012 and Work Health & Safety Regulations 2022			
Codes of Practice			
Confined Spaces - 2020	Hazardous Manual Tasks - 2020	Managing Noise & Preventing Hearing Loss at Work-2020	Managing Risks of Plant in the Workplace - 2018
Construction Work - 2020	How to Manage WH&S Risks - 2018	Managing Risk of Falls at Workplaces - 2020	Managing Electrical Risks in the Workplace -2019
Excavation Work - 2020	First Aid in the Workplace - 2018	Managing Work Environment & Facilities - 2020	WHS Consultation Co-operation & Co-ordination - 2018
Welding Processes - 2021	How to Safely Remove Asbestos - 2020	Managing Risk of Hazardous Chemicals - 2018	Safe Design of Structures - 2018

Plant & Equipment for this activity

- All plant is inspected prior to sending out to site
- Daily maintenance & service checks.
- Daily pre-start checks are conducted on all plant and trucks by the operators and daily checklist filled out.
- Regular servicing at 250hr intervals or as per manufactures specifications. Service History available on request to the office.

List of plant for this Activity
Engineering details/certificates/regulatory approvals/permits/electrical isolation (if applicable):

WORK ACTIVITY BRIEFING

Implementation, Monitoring and Review of SWMS

The Supervisor on site has the responsibility to:

- Brief each team member on this SWMS before commencing work.
- Ensure control measures have been implemented prior to the start of works.
- Observe work being carried out.
- If controls documented in SWMS are not adequate, stop the work, review the SWMS, adjust as required and re-brief the team.
- Ensure team knows that work is to immediately stop if the SWMS is not being followed.
- Retain this SWMS on site for the duration of the high-risk construction work.
- All persons involved in these particular tasks on site must sign this document as read and understood.

SWMS attendance sheet — I have been given the opportunity to provide input into the development and review of this SWMS

Name (please print clearly)	Signature	Company	Date

Daily pre-start meetings will be held to ensure all workers are informed of control measures and additional safety hazards & controls to be noted on toolbox form.